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DEMOGRAPHIC HISTORY OF GALICIA AND VOLHYNIA (10000BC - 1300AD).

Regional Boundaries, Devolved Principalities and Population Estimates in South-Western Rus.

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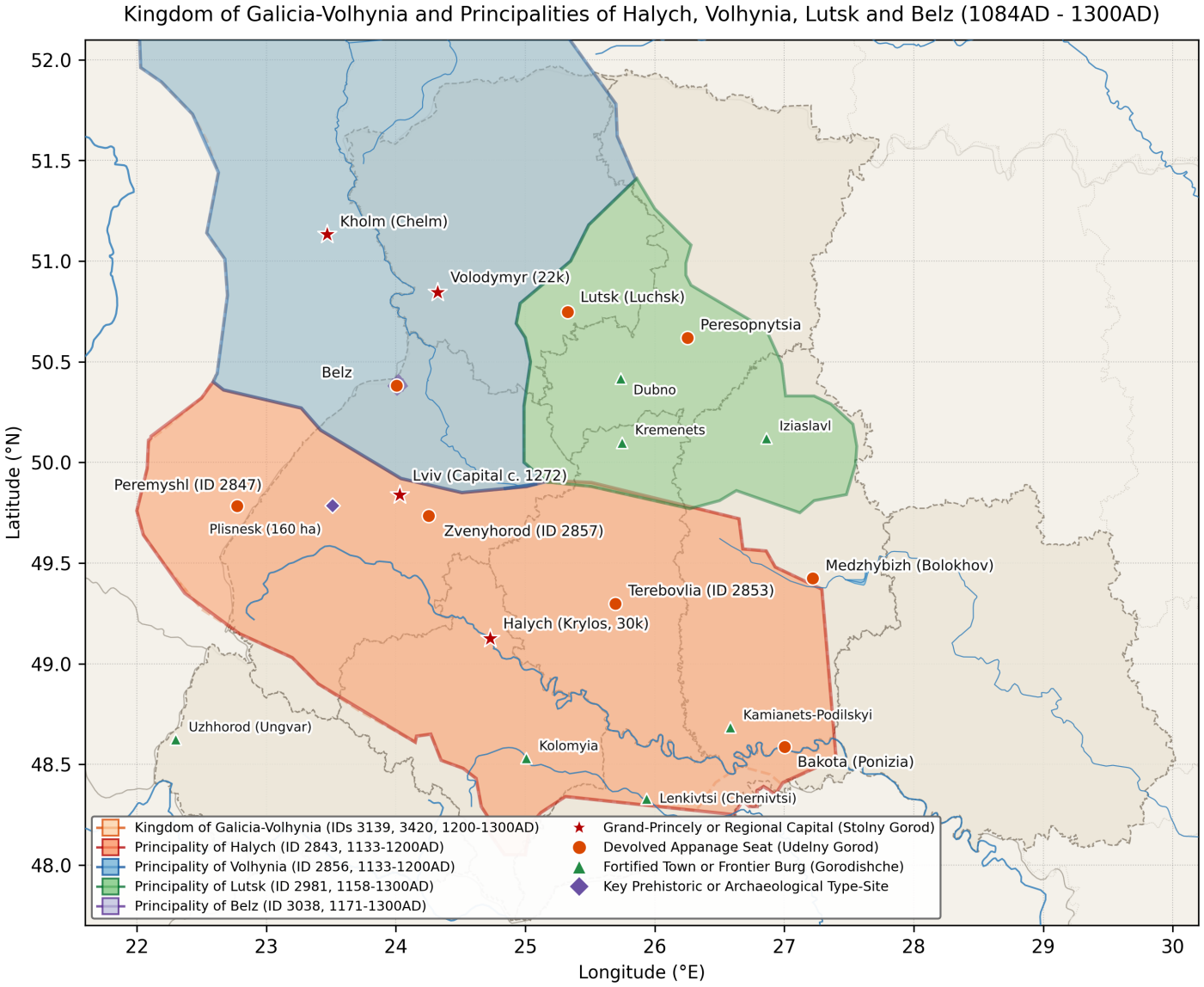


Figure 1. Regional Boundaries and Fortified Settlement Hierarchy of the Principalities of Galicia, Volhynia, Lutsk, Belz and Ponizia (10000BC - 1300AD).

Executive Summary and Geographic Scope

This literature review establishes the empirical baseline and settlement-level demographic reconstruction for Region 3 (Galicia and Volhynia) of the Kievan Rus regional sub-series (Stadester and Substrata), book-ended chronologically from the Upper Palaeolithic (10000BC) to the Mongol Conquests (1240-1241AD campaign of Batu Khan across Volhynia and Galicia) and the immediate post-conquest Romanovichi Kingdom of Galicia-Volhynia (Kingdom of Rus) (1250AD - 1300AD) [1][2][3]. Geographically, the region spans nine modern western and right-bank Ukrainian ADM1 Oblasts (~176 200 km^2) across the Upper and Middle Dniester, Western Bug, San, Styr, Horyn, Upper Pripyat, Upper Prut and Upper Tisza river basins. Within the `saves/atlas_defacto.naissance` historical polity mask, this territory forms the south-western march of unified Kievan Rus (2137, 981-1133AD) and subsequently partitions into the Rostislavichi Galician principalities, the Monomakhovichi and Romanovichi Volhynian principalities and the unified Kingdom of Galicia-Volhynia (Kingdom of Rus) (3139, 3251, 3372, 3420, 1199-1341AD):

1. **Rostislavichi Galician Principalities** (49 600 km^2 across Lvivska, Ivano-Frankivska, Ternopilska and the San-Cherven strip): Encompassing the Principality of Peremyshl (2847, 1133-1142AD, 49,78°N, 22,77°E), the Principality of Zvenyhorod (2857, 1133-1142AD, 49,73°N, 24,25°E), the Principality of Terebovlia (2853, 1133-1142AD, 49,30°N, 25,69°E) and the unified Principality of Halych (2843, 1133-1200AD, 49,12°N, 24,73°E), consolidated by Vladimirko Volodarevich (1141-1144AD) and Yaroslav Osmomysl (1153-1187AD) around the 200 ha metropolitan complex of Halych (*Krylos*, 30,0k at 1200AD) [4][5][6].
2. **Monomakhovichi and Romanovichi Volhynian Principalities** (40 190 km^2 across Volynska, Rivnenska and Left-Bank Western Bug): Encompassing the Principality of Volhynia (2856, 1133-1200AD, 50,85°N, 24,32°E) centred on Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*, 75 ha, 22,0k at 1200AD) and Daniel's royal capital at Kholm (*Chelm*, 8,0k in 1240AD and 12,0k in 1300AD), the Principality of Lutsk (2981, 1158-1324AD, 50,75°N, 25,33°E) across the Styr, Ikva and Horyn (*Pogoryrina*) basins (*Lutsk 10,0k*, *Peresopnytsia 5,0k*, *Dorogobuzh 4,5k*, *Kremenets 4,0k*, *Iziaslavl*) and the Principality of Belz (3038, 1171-1367AD, 50,38°N, 24,01°E) (*Belz 6,0k*, *Busk 4,0k*) [2][3][7].
3. **Ponizia** (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya, Transcarpathia and Maritime Outposts (86 410 km^2 across Khmelnytska, Vinnytska, Chernivetska, Zakarpatska and Pontic exclaves): Encompassing the Middle Dniester canyon of Ponizia (*Bakota 26 ha, 5,5k*, *Kamianets 22 ha, 4,0k*, *Ushitsa*, *Kalius*, *Kuchelmin*), the Western Bolokhov Land (*Medzhybizh 4,0k*, *Bozhsky*), Shipenitskaya Zemlya (Northern Bukovina) (*Lenkivtsi (*Chern*) on Prut 3,5k*, *Khotyn*), Subcarpathian Rus (*Uzhhorod (*Ungvar*) 3,5k*, *Mukachevo*) and the Pontic-Crimean outposts of the Principality of Tmutarakan (2854, 988-1100sAD) and the Principality of Mangup (*Theodoro*) (3218, 1204-1300AD) [8][9][10].

Across the Holocene and pre-Mongol medieval era, South-Western Rus experienced four major demographic cycles prior to Batu Khan's 1240-1241AD campaign: (i) the Trypillia-Cucuteni Dniester-Prut-Bug Eneolithic climax (c. 3500BC, 260,0k) anchored by *Bilche-Zolote (Verteba)*, *Koshylivtsi*, *Bodaki*, *Zalishchyky* and *Stina* [11]; (ii) the Vysotska and Early Scythian West Podolian hillfort horizon (c. 500BC, 490,0k) centred on the 110 ha giant rampart hillfort at *Nemyriv*, *Severynivka* and *Hryhorivka* [12]; (iii) the Chernyakhov, Lipitsa, Przeworsk and Carpathian Tumuli Culture optimum (c. 300AD, 680,0k) [13][14]; and (iv) the Galician-Volhynian urban and rural apogee (1000AD - 1200AD), when 350 fortified *gorodishcha* and rich sub-Carpathian salt-boiling centres supported 1,15M in 1000AD, 1,46M in 1100AD and 1,82M in 1200AD [6][15][16]. Following the 1240-1241AD Mongol destruction of Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Iziaslavl and Kolodyazhyn, regional population contracted to a post-conquest trough of 1,24M in 1250AD (-31,9% from 1200AD), before recovering under King Daniel Romanovich (crowned 1253AD), Lev Danilovich and Yuri I Lvovich around the new royal capitals of *Kholm* and *Lviv* to 1,38M in 1300AD [5][17].

Prehistoric and Iron Age Settlement (10000BC - 500AD)

Upper Palaeolithic, Neolithic and Trypillia-Cucuteni Eneolithic (10000BC - 1500BC)

Unlike the glaciated northern forest basins of European Russia, the deep limestone canyons of the Middle Dniester, Prut and upper Volhynian uplands functioned as one of Europe's primary periglacial refugia throughout the terminal Pleistocene (10000BC) [18]. Multilayered open-air camp complexes at Molodova I and Molodova V, Korman IV, Babin I and Voronovitsa along the Dniester canyon, together with the Korolevo sequence on the Tisza in Transcarpathia and Kulychivka (at Kremenets) in Volhynia, preserve continuous Magdalenian and Epigravettian mammoth- and reindeer-hunter horizons supporting a 10000BC regional population of 16,0k (16 000, range 8,0k - 28,0k) [18].

During the Early Holocene (6500BC - 4500BC), indigenous Mesolithic fisher-foragers of the Bug-Dniester Culture (*Soroky*, *Bazkiv Ostriv*, *Pechera* and *Sokoltsi* on the Southern Bug) adopted early ceramics and domesticated plants through interaction with Linearbandkeramik (LBK) agriculturalists advancing along the Carpathian piedmont into the Upper Dniester and Western Bug loess terraces (*Nezvysko*, *Torskie*, *Zymne*, *Kotiv* and *Rivne*) [11]. By 5000BC, permanent LBK longhouse villages and Bug-Dniester riverine settlements supported 65,0k (65 000) inhabitants.

Between 4200BC and 3000BC, the Dniester-Prut-Southern Bug plateaus and southern Volhynian uplands formed the western heartland of the Trypillia-Cucuteni Culture (Stages BI-BII and CI-CII), with over 800 documented settlements [11]:

- **Upper and Middle Dniester Loess Terraces and Ritual Caves**: Multiphase promontory settlements and ritual labyrinth caves at Bilche-Zolote (Verteba Cave) (2,5k), Koshylivtsi-Oboz (2,5k), Zalishchyky (2,2k), Nezvysko (1,8k), Horodnytsia (1,8k), Buchach (1,6k) and Polivanov Yar (1,5k) [11].
- **Volhynian-Horyn Flint Mining and Workshop Zone**: Late Trypillian (CI-CII) fortified promontory settlements at Bodaki on the Horyn (2,0k), Zymne, Khoriv and Lystvyn, which mined and exported high-grade Turonian dark flint blades across the Carpathian-Pontic region [11].
- **Eastern Podolian and Southern Bug Corridor**: Large concentric-plan settlements at Stina (3,0k), Nemyriv (2,2k) and Klishchiv (2,0k) bridging the Dniester valley and the Bug-Dnieper mega-site zone.

At the 3500BC Eneolithic benchmark, the regional population reached 260,0k (260 000, range 180,0k - 360,0k). During the Early and Middle Bronze Age (2500BC - 1200BC), pastoral Corded Ware (*Pidkarpatska kultura shnurovoi keramiky*), Komariv (centred on *Komariv* near Halych, exploiting sub-Carpathian salt springs and Transylvanian bronze trade) and Noua communities expanded across the Carpathian piedmont and Volhynian forest-steppe, raising regional population to 310,0k (310 000) at 1500BC [6].

Scythian West Podolian Hillforts and the Chernyakhov Optimum (500BC - 500AD)

In the Early Iron Age (700BC - 300BC), the Hallstatt-influenced Vysotska Culture (Lvivska and Ternopilska Oblasts) and the Early Scythian West Podolian Group along the Middle Dniester and Southern Bug erected monumental earthen-rampart hillforts [12]. The paramount regional stronghold was the Nemyriv Giant Hillfort (*Nemyrivske horodyshche*) (48,97°N, 28,84°E), enclosed by 9 m-high ramparts (5,5 km perimeter) encompassing 110 ha, with Milesian and Attic black-glazed pottery (6th - 5th c. BC) and an estimated population of 4,5k (4 500) [12]. Alongside sister hillforts at Severynivka (2,5k), Hryhorivka (2,2k), Chornoliska and Vysotske, South-Western Rus supported 490,0k (490 000) inhabitants at 500BC.

During the Roman Imperial period (100AD - 400AD), the Lipitsa (Dacian-Thracian salt-workers of the Upper Dniester), Przeworsk, Wielbark (along the Western Bug and Styr), Carpathian Tumuli and Zubrytska cultures coalesced in the 3rd - 4th centuries AD into the provincial-Roman agricultural

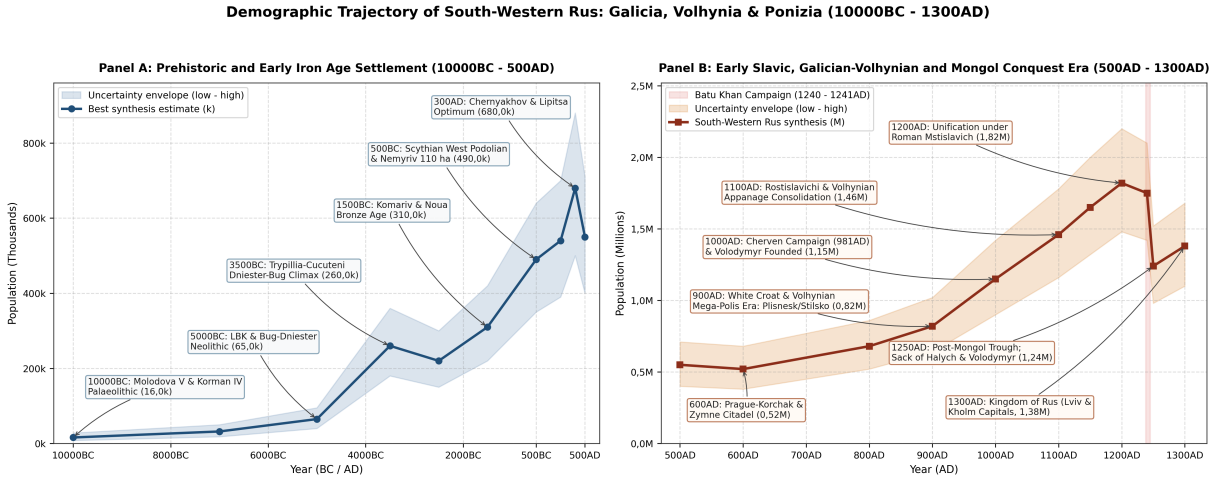


Figure 2. Demographic Trajectory of South-Western Rus: Galicia, Volhynia and Ponizia (10000BC - 1300AD).

expansion of the Chernyakhov Culture [13][14]. Excavations at Ripniv II, Lepesivka, Bovshiv, Demianiv, Cherneliv-Ruskyi, Bakota and Sokol document heavy iron-shod plough cultivation, rotary querns, glass-working kilns and Roman denarius hoards, driving the regional population to an antique optimum of 680,0k (680 000) at 300AD [13].

Benchmark	Galicia Core (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Terebovlia)	Volhynia, Lutsk & Belz	Ponizia (Podolia) & Bolokhov West	Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total (Range)
10000BC	6,0k	4,0k	4,0k	2,0k	16,0k (8 - 28k)
5000BC	26,0k	18,0k	14,0k	7,0k	65,0k (40 - 95k)
3500BC	105,0k	65,0k	62,0k	28,0k	260,0k (180 - 360k)
1500BC	125,0k	85,0k	65,0k	35,0k	310,0k (220 - 420k)
500BC	195,0k	125,0k	120,0k	50,0k	490,0k (350 - 640k)
300AD	275,0k	180,0k	155,0k	70,0k	680,0k (500 - 880k)
600AD	215,0k	145,0k	105,0k	55,0k	520,0k (380 - 680k)
800AD	340,0k	215,0k	80,0k	45,0k	680,0k (520 - 860k)
900AD	415,0k	260,0k	95,0k	50,0k	820,0k (640 - 1 020k)

Table 1. Prehistoric, Antique and Early Slavic Demographic Trajectory of South-Western Rus (10000BC - 900AD).

Early Slavic and Galician-Volhynian Era (600AD - 1300AD)

Prague-Korchak Strongholds and Tribal Mega-Polis Centres (600AD - 980AD)

Following the post-Chernyakhov restructuring (5th - 6th c. AD), the Upper Dniester, Western Bug and Styr-Horyn basins became the primary core of the Early Slavic Prague-Korchak Culture (520,0k regional population at 600AD) [14][19]. At Zymne on the Luha River near Volodymyr (50,80°N, 24,33°E), V. V. Aulikh excavated a 6th - 7th c. AD timber-palisaded citadel (1,5k inhabitants) yielding non-ferrous jewellery moulds, iron weapons, silvered belt mounts and Byzantine coins of Justinian I and Justin II (527-578AD), destroyed during the Avar wars against the *Duliby* [19]. Contemporaneous early Slavic settlements flourished at Ripniv, Bovshiv, Zelene, Krylos and Rashkiv [14].

During the Luka-Raikovetska tribal era (800AD 680,0k; 900AD 820,0k), the White Croats, Volhynians and Buzhany and Tivertsi constructed monumental polycentric hillforts (*gorodishcha*): Plisnesk (160 ha across seven defensive rampart lines, 6,0k in 900AD) [20], Stilsko (200 ha enclosure on the Kolodnytsia with 10 km of ramparts, 7,0k in 900AD), Old Halych (*Krylos*) (4,5k in 900AD), Revne (2,5k), Volyn (*Grudek*) (3,5k), Cherven (3,0k), Busk (*Buzhsk*) (2,5k) and Peremyshl (3,5k) [2][6][9]. After Grand Prince Vladimir the Great's 981AD Cherven campaign, his 992AD Croat campaign and the foundation of Volodymyr (988AD), regional population reached 1,15M (1 150,0k) at 1000AD [2].

Devolved Principalities of Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod, Terebovlia, Volhynia, Lutsk and Belz (1084AD - 1200AD)

Between 1084AD (when the Rostislavichi brothers established independent rule in Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod and Terebovlia, ratified at the 1097AD Council of Liubech) and 1199AD (when Roman Mstislavich united Galicia and Volhynia), South-Western Rus developed the densest network of fortified towns in Kievan Rus (350 excavated *gorodishcha* catalogued by A. V. Kuza and B. P. Tomenchuk: 92 in Halych and Terebovlia, 64 in Peremyshl and Zvenyhorod, 78 in Volhynia and Belz, 68 in Lutsk and Pogoryrina and 48 in Ponizia and Bukovina) [6][16][21]:

1. **Principality of Halych** (2843, 1133-1200AD, 49,12°N, 24,73°E): Unified by Vladimirko Volodarevich (1141-1144AD) and Yaroslav Osmomysl (1153-1187AD). Its capital at Halych (*Krylos*) encompassed a 200 ha polycentric agglomeration along the Lukva and Dniester featuring the white-stone Dormition Cathedral (1157AD) and St. Panteleimon Church, housing 30,0k (30 000) inhabitants at 1200AD [4][5][6], supported by the sub-Carpathian salt-boiling centres of Kolomyia (3,5k), Zudechev (Zhydachiv) (3,0k), Sudova Vyshnia (2,5k), Drohobych (2,2k), Dolyna (2,0k) and the rock fortress of Tustan (1,2k).
2. **Principality of Peremyshl** (2847, 1133-1142AD, 49,78°N, 22,77°E): Centred on Peremyshl (*Przemysl*) (38 ha *detinets* with stone rotunda and *palatium* and *posad*, 9,0k at 1200AD), alongside Yaroslav (3,5k), Sanok (2,5k) and Sambir (2,2k) [5].
3. **Principality of Zvenyhorod** (2857, 1133-1142AD, 49,73°N, 24,25°E): Centred on Zvenyhorod (45 ha citadel and waterlogged *posad* yielding Birch-Bark Letters Nos. 1-3, 10,0k at 1200AD) and Plisnesk (4,5k in 1200AD) and after c. 1256AD replaced by Lviv (12,0k by 1300AD) [5][20].
4. **Principality of Terebovlia** (2853, 1133-1142AD, 49,30°N, 25,69°E): Centred on Terebovlia (30 ha, 6,5k at 1200AD), Vasyliv on the Dniester (35 ha with white-stone church, 5,0k at 1200AD), Mykulyntsi (2,2k), Zbarazh (2,0k) and Onut (1,8k) [1][9].
5. **Principality of Volhynia** (2856, 1133-1200AD, 50,85°N, 24,32°E): Centred on Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*) (75 ha rampart and *posad* complex with the 1160AD Mstislav Dormition Cathedral, 22,0k at 1200AD), Kholm (*Chelm*) (Daniel's royal capital from c. 1237AD, 36 ha, 8,0k at

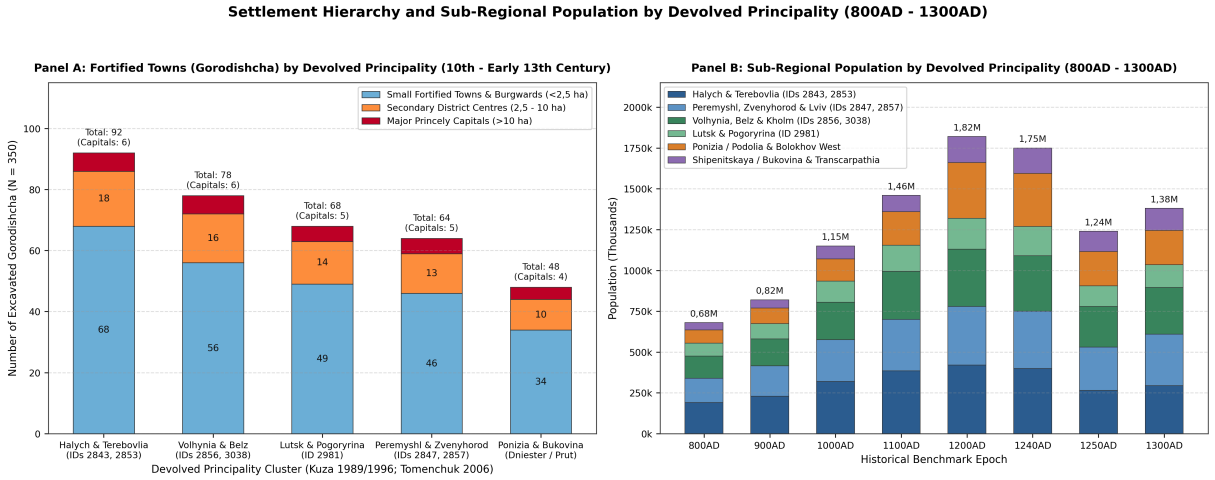


Figure 3. Settlement Hierarchy and Sub-Regional Population by Devolved Principality (800AD - 1300AD).

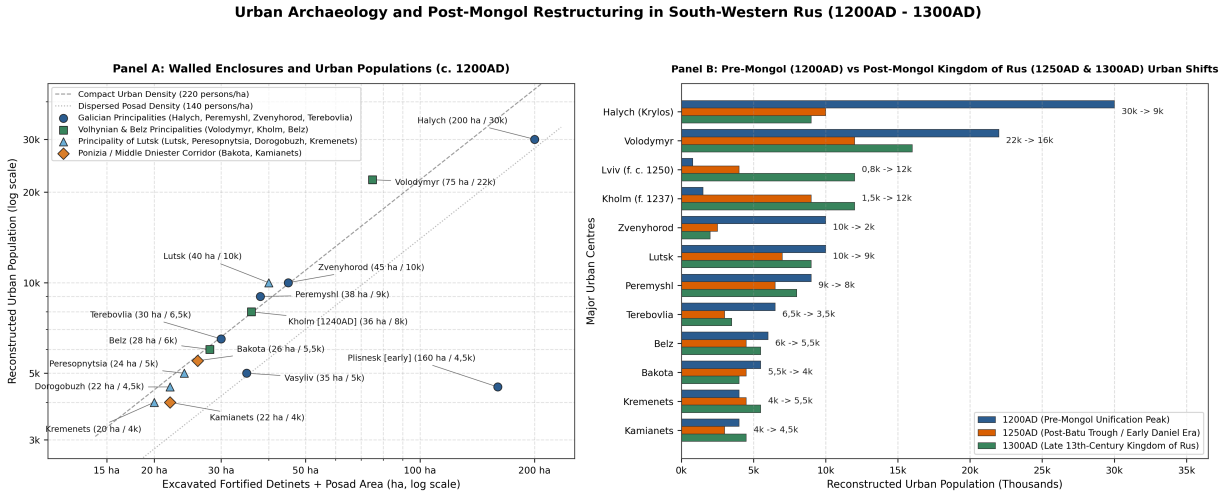


Figure 4. Urban Archaeology and Post-Mongol Restructuring in South-Western Rus (1200AD - 1300AD).

1240AD and 12,0k at 1300AD), Cherven (3,5k), Ugrovesk (2,8k), Liuboml (2,5k), Vsevolozh (2,2k), Suteisk (2,0k) and Volyn (*Grudek*) (1,8k) [2][22].

6. **Principality of Lutsk** (2981, 1158-1324AD, 50,75°N, 25,33°E): Centred on Lutsk (*Luchsk*) (40 ha, 10,0k at 1200AD), Peresopnytsia (24 ha, 5,0k), Dorogobuzh-on-Horyn (22 ha, 4,5k), Kremenets (20 ha, 4,0k), Iziaslavl (2,8k in 1200AD; burned 1241AD horizon excavated by M. K. Karger), Dubno (2,8k), Shumsk (2,8k), Ostroh (2,5k), Chortoryisk (2,2k), Danyliv (2,0k), Stepan (2,0k) and Peremyl (2,0k) [7][23].
7. **Principality of Belz** (3038, 1171-1367AD, 50,38°N, 24,01°E): Centred on Belz (28 ha, 6,0k at 1200AD), Busk (*Buzhsk*) (22 ha, 4,0k) and Sokal (1,8k) [5].
8. **Ponizia** (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya, Transcarpathia and Maritime Outposts (3139, 2854, 3218): Centred on Bakota (26 ha, 5,5k), Kamianets (22 ha, 4,0k), Medzhybizh (4,0k), Bozhsky (3,5k), Lenkivtsi (*Chern*) on Prut (3,5k), Uzhhorod (*Ungvar*) (3,5k), Ushitsa (3,0k), Khotyn (3,0k), Kalius (2,5k), Mukachevo (2,5k), Kuchelmin (2,0k), plus Tmutarakan (2854) (8,0k in 1050-1100AD) and Mangup (*Theodoro*) (3218) (6,5k in 1250-1300AD) [8][9].

The 1240-1241AD Mongol Conquests and the Post-Conquest Kingdom of Rus (1240AD - 1300AD)

On the eve of Batu Khan's western campaign (1240AD), the unified Romanovichi realm supported 1,75M (1 750,0k) inhabitants (down slightly from the 1,82M 1200AD unification peak due to the 1205-1238AD boyar and Hungarian wars of succession). During the winter campaign of December 1240AD - March 1241AD, Mongol armies stormed and burned Iziaslavl, Kolodyazhyn, Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Peresopnytsia and Terebovlia, reducing the regional population to a post-conquest trough of 1,24M (1 240,0k) in 1250AD (-31,9% below 1200AD) [17][23]. However, because the cliff fortresses of Kremenets and Danyliv, the new royal capital at Kholm, Bakota in Ponizia and the Carpathian mountain valleys survived intact, King Daniel Romanovich (crowned *Rex Russiae* at Dorohychyn in 1253AD), Vasilko Romanovich, Lev Danilovich (who made Lviv the supreme capital in 1272AD) and Yuri I Lvovich spearheaded a rapid demographic and urban recovery (polity ID 3420, Kingdom of Rus), reaching 1,38M (1 380,0k) by 1300AD [1][5][22].

Benchmark	Halych & Terebovlia (2843, 2853)	Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Lviv (2847, 2857)	Volhynia, Belz & Kholm (2856, 3038)	Principality of Lutsk (2981)	Ponizia, Bolokhov, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total
1000AD	320,0k	255,0k	230,0k	130,0k	215,0k	1,15M (1 150,0k)
1100AD	385,0k	315,0k	295,0k	160,0k	305,0k	1,46M (1 460,0k)
1150AD	405,0k	340,0k	325,0k	175,0k	405,0k	1,65M (1 650,0k)
1200AD	420,0k	360,0k	350,0k	190,0k	500,0k	1,82M (1 820,0k)
1240AD	400,0k	350,0k	340,0k	180,0k	480,0k	1,75M (1 750,0k)
1250AD	265,0k	265,0k	250,0k	125,0k	335,0k	1,24M (1 240,0k)
1300AD	295,0k	315,0k	285,0k	140,0k	345,0k	1,38M (1 380,0k)

Table 2. Medieval Sub-Regional Population Breakdown by Devolved Principality Cluster (1000AD - 1300AD).

Cross-Regional Synthesis (1000AD - 1300AD)

To ensure full demographic consistency across the SVEA historical dataset, Table 3 cross-references South-Western Rus (Galicia and Volhynia) with the northern and eastern Rus principalities documented in the companion European Russia regional review [3][15][21].

Polity / Regional Unit	1000AD Pop.	1100AD Pop.	1200AD Apogee	1250AD Trough	1300AD Pop.
Galician Principalities (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod, Terebovlia)	575,0k	700,0k	780,0k	530,0k	610,0k
Volhynian Principalities (Volodymyr, Kholm, Lutsk, Belz)	360,0k	455,0k	540,0k	375,0k	425,0k
Ponizia (Podolia), Bolokhov West, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	215,0k	305,0k	500,0k	335,0k	345,0k
Region 3 Subtotal (galicia_and_volhynia)	1,15M	1,46M	1,82M	1,24M	1,38M
cf. Vladimir-Suzdal / Rostov (european_russia)	340,0k	510,0k	780,0k	520,0k	640,0k
cf. Novgorod & Pskov Republics (european_russia)	290,0k	380,0k	480,0k	460,0k	510,0k
cf. Principality of Smolensk (european_russia)	210,0k	275,0k	340,0k	290,0k	310,0k
cf. Total european_russia Benchmark	2,15M	2,90M	3,85M	2,80M	3,10M

Table 3. Cross-Regional Demographic Synthesis: South-Western Rus (galicia_and_volhynia) vs. Northern/Eastern Rus (european_russia, 1000AD - 1300AD).

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